

STATE OF NORTH CAROLINA

COUNTY OF VANCE

The Vance County Board of Commissioners met in a special-called meeting on Tuesday, December 16, 2025, at 4:00 p.m. in the Commissioners' Conference Room, Vance County Administration Building, 122 Young Street, Henderson, NC. Those Commissioners present were as follows: Commissioner Carolyn Faines, Commissioner Charisse Fain, Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, Commissioner Yolanda Feimster, Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr, and Commissioner Valencia Perry.

Absent: Thomas S. Hester, Jr.

Also present were County Manager C. Renee Perry, Assistant County Manager Jeremy Jones, Finance Director Stephanie Williams, County Attorney Jonathan S. Care, and Clerk to the Board Dywanda Pettaway.

Commissioner Faines gave the invocation.

As advertised, at 4:00 p.m., a public hearing was held to receive the Planning Board recommendation, staff and public comments, and take formal action on the following Zoning Map Amendments: Case ZMA25-003 and Case ZMA25-004.

Mrs. Sherry Moss, Planning and Development Director, stated that the purpose of the hearing is to review and make a recommendation regarding a Zoning Map Amendment (ZMA) request for two parcels of properties located off Hwy 158 Business (ZMA25-003 & ZMA25-004) from employment and institutional area (EIA) to light industrial (LI). Staff recommend approval of the rezoning request from EIA to LI. The request is consistent with the adopted 1996 comprehensive plan with regards to goals two and four accommodating economic development and growth and expanding the economic tax base and the 2010 future land use map with regards to the industrial and warehousing land use classification.

Commissioner Carolyn Faines then asked if there was anyone from the public that would like to comment on the Zoning Map Amendments. There was one that spoke. She stated, my name is Beth Treyos. I'm an attorney with Fox Rothschild and I'm here today with Michael Nutelli from Nutelli Holdings to request your support for this proposed rezoning. As your planning director capably described, this proposal is compliant with your long-range comprehensive plan for this area. The reason zoning would align these tracks with the adjacent tracks to the west, north, and east which have in the not-too-distant past also been zoned light industrial. This will encourage

economic development and the expansion of tax base both of which are goals of your comprehensive plan. Your professional planning staff recommends approval. Your planning board unanimously recommended approval and we hope that that you will join them in uh moving to approve the proposed rezoning.

As there was no one else who wished to speak on the matter, Commissioner Carolyn Faines declared the public hearing closed.

Motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt to approve the zoning change on ZMA25-003 and ZMA25-004 to light industrial given that it is in best interest by promoting additional economic development activities within the county allowing for logical expansion of light industrial zone proposed development activity use in the area and will continue to promote a diverse economic tax base. This motion was seconded by Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. and the vote was unanimous.

The Fiscal Operations Policy. Stephanie Williams, Finance Director, at your October work session, staff presented the draft fiscal operations policy. There were some questions that have been answered via email to the Board of County Commissioners by County Manager Perry on November 14, 2025. Today, after staff and legal have reviewed it, The Fiscal Operations Policy is respectfully submitted for the Board of County Commissioners' consideration and approval. This policy establishes clear, uniform standards for financial practices across all County departments and outlines the procedures necessary to ensure accountability, transparency, and compliance with North Carolina General Statutes governing public finance. While state law provides the minimum requirements—and grants certain officials discretion regarding when bidding is required or when specific purchasing thresholds apply—this policy is designed to reflect best practice, not minimum practice. The intention is to create a consistent, disciplined framework that supports the long-term financial health of Vance County.

Over the last several years, the County has experienced significant financial challenges. These challenges highlight the need for strong, predictable internal controls and a unified approach to spending, purchasing, and fiscal decision-making. A best-practice policy reduces risk, prevents inconsistent application of procedures, and reinforces the stewardship expected of public officials managing taxpayer dollars. The Fiscal Operations Policy should serve as the County's standard, not a document of optional guidelines or exceptions. While the General Statutes outline when bidding is required, who has procurement authority, and the minimum financial controls needed,

this policy goes further by incorporating safeguards that are appropriate for an organization recovering from financial instability. It ensures that: all departments follow the same processes for procurement, purchasing, and documentation, financial approvals and spending authority are exercised responsibly and consistently, the County avoids unnecessary risk, audit findings, and vulnerabilities due to inconsistent practices, and that staff understand expectations clearly and operate within a transparent and accountable framework.

Adopting the Fiscal Operations Policy as written will support stronger internal controls, enhance public trust, and create a more stable financial environment. It reflects a deliberate shift from operating at the minimum statutory requirements to operating at the highest professional standard for public fiscal management. For these reasons, I respectfully request the Board's approval of the Fiscal Operations Policy.

Following discussion, Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. made a motion to approve the Fiscal Operations Policy, which was seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain. The motion failed by a vote of 3 to 3. Those voting in favor were Commissioner Carolyn Faines, Commissioner Charisse Fain, and Commissioner Leo Kelly, Jr. Those voting against were Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, Commissioner Yolanda Feimster, and Commissioner Valencia Perry. Accordingly, the motion failed, and the Fiscal Operations Policy was denied.

As there was no further business, at 4:39 p.m., motion was made by Commissioner R. Dan Brummitt, seconded by Commissioner Charisse Fain, vote was unanimous, that the meeting be adjourned.

Approved and signed January 5, 2026.

Carolyn Faines *(signed)*
Carolyn Faines, Chair